WORKSHOP SESSION

Vibe Coding: From Idea to MVP at Warp Speed

> This is not a talk. You're going to **build**, **think**, and **explain**.

SXSW 2026 WORKSHOP

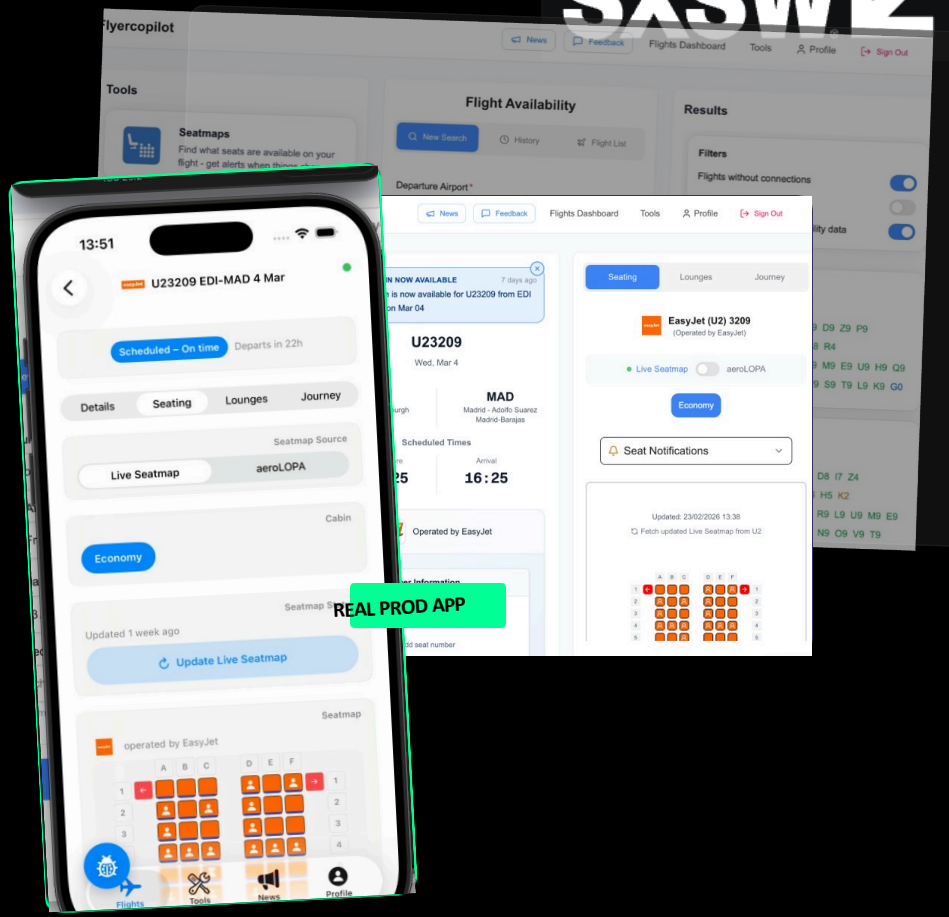
INTRODUCTIONS

The Context

I Built This Alone.

- Complex system. **Built solo.**
- Felt **overwhelming.**
- Worked because of **modular thinking.**

Credibility Checkpoint



The Evolution

From Newbie to Launch

Timeframe: A Few Months

DEV PATH

Total Newbie → Competent → Master Vibe Coder

FOUNDER PATH

Grand Idea → First Fail → PM / SE Mindset → Successful Launch

01 First Principles Matter

Customer Problem → Architecture → Roadmap (Idea > Prototype > MVP > Features).

02 Control the Code

Understand exactly what AI is building. Don't fly blind.

03 Rigour > Speed

AI doesn't cut corners if it knows the full mission. Be explicit.

04 Kill the Guesswork

Use .cursorrules to force questions. "Ask me before you guess."

You are Product Manager + Software Engineer// AI is the Developer

DEFINITION PHASE

What Vibe Coding Actually Is

IS

Intent → Structure → Code

Modular
Small, testable blocks.

Anchored Context
Providing the "Why" before the "How".

VS

IS NOT

Prompt Magic
Hoping for the best.

One-shot Apps
Building entire systems at once.

Replacing Thinking
The AI is the hands, you are the head.

THE PROCESS

The Vibe Coding Loop

1. **Explain**
   Speak naturally. Define the "Why".
2. **Plan**
   Verify structure before code.
3. **Build**
   Generate code blocks.
4. **Observe**
   Check against reality.
5. **Refine**
   Adjust intent and iterate.

"AI reflects the clarity you give it."

INTERMISSION!

The Vision

Today We Will Build

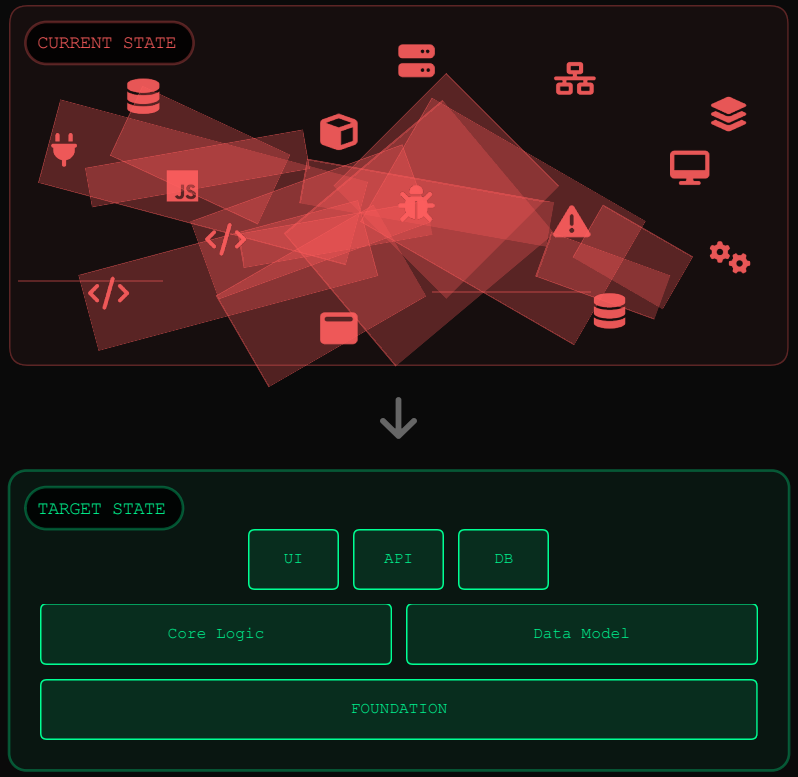
'Event Builder 360'

- Official event data
- Community augmentation
- Ratings & notes
- Discovery
- Multi-event future

Feels overwhelming.

That's normal.

HE TARGET STATE



> **Overwhelm** doesn't mean 'don't build'.

PLAN WELL

Architecture • Data • Flows • Roadmap

BUILD MODULAR

Start small • Add incrementally • One block at a time

KEEP PLANNING

Plans evolve as you learn • Stay current

SECTION 1

PLAN WELL

Architecture • Strategy • Roadmap

STATUS REPORT

Planning for Event Builder 360

Big Idea
Vision defined. Scope clear.

Problem Definition
Incomplete. Needs specific user pain points.

Technical Planning
Partially done. Cursor Rules, Folder Structure, Architecture prepared.

Code Framework
Initial prototype scaffolded.

Modular Coding
Not started. Next phase.

LEGO Warm-Up

Get your hands moving

3 Minutes

Build a tower.

Required

Must include a minifigure.

30 Seconds Each

Explain one special thing.

Activity Phase

Exercise : Problem Ideation

Thinking about Event Apps and the Topics below

WHAT DRIVES YOU MAD?

If you could change/fix ONE THING what would it be?

- Session Registration/Reserving
- Ticketing
- Networking/Social/Community
- What Else is Going On (in Austin)
- Hotels and Travel
- Speakers/Performers Portal
- App Useability
- Hosting an Event
- Event Directories
- Passes and Registration

Activity Phase

Exercise : Problem Ideation

WHAT DRIVES YOU MAD?

1. Build a LEGO model to describe the issue – 5 Minutes
2. Each person describes their model to their table – 1 minute each
3. The Table selects their favourite problem to be brought forward – 2 minutes
4. We will go around the room to share the chosen problem from each table

- Session Registration/Reserving
- Ticketing
- Networking/Social/Community
- What Else is Going On (in Austin)
- Hotels and Travel
- Speakers/Performers Portal
- App Useability
- Hosting an Event
- Event Directories
- Passes and Registration

SECTION 2

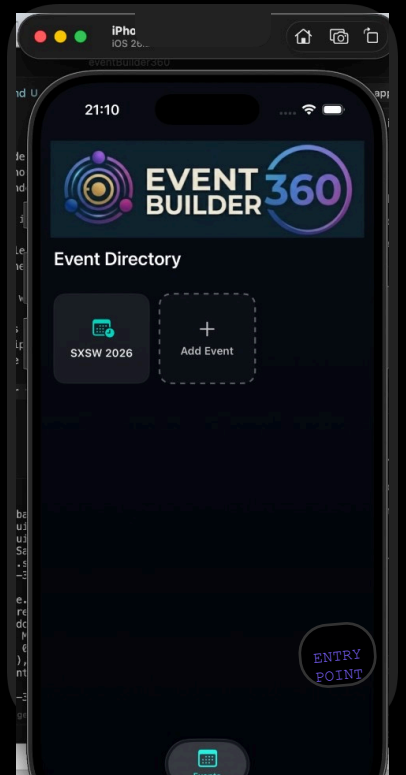
BUILD MODULAR

THE STARTING POINT

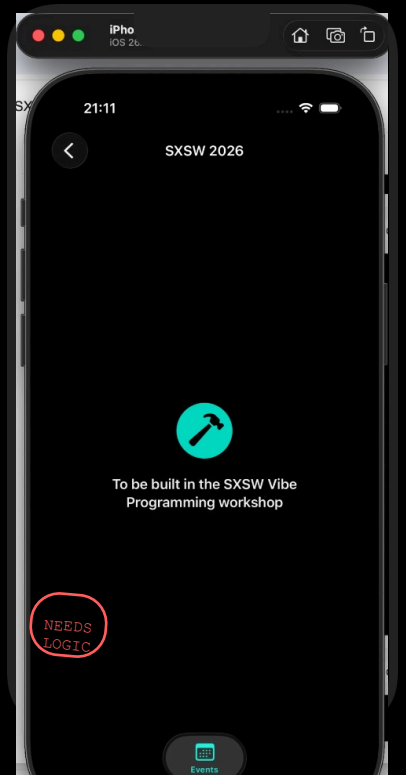
Modular Building in Action

REPO: v1.0.0-starter

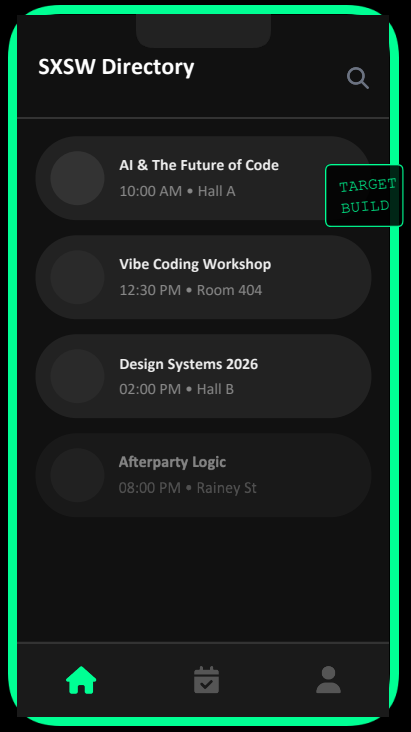
Pre-Built



Current State



Current Task



Event List

METHODOLOGY

Tried & Tested: The 6-Step Prompt Structure

framework_v1.md

1 The Task in Hand

1 The Event Home Screen is currently empty
I'd like it to show a list of Event Activities with an option to add an activity'

2.x Sub-Task Details

2.1 Each event activity should be a card
Tapping the card should open a new screen with full activity details

3.x Data & Interactions

3.1 We will need an eventActivities table with appropriate meta data columns - eg time (local), location, title, description, speakers, type etc'
3.2 We will need to allow all users read/write access to this table as we don't have auth in place for this prototyping
3.3 We will need to populate the table with some sample SXSW events - eg this event, the keynote, and maybe some music and film events

4 Code vs. No-Code Decision

Option A: "What do you think, can you suggest more detail for our table columns?"
Option B: "NO CODE YET - just looking for ideas."

5 The Magic Question

"Do you have any questions before we start?" // Always ask this.

6 Other Considerations

"We will get this base framework done first, then work on an 'Add Activity' modal."

PRO TIP This structure prevents "Context Drift" by anchoring the AI before it writes code.

Over to you Claude/ChatGPT

System Alert

Error 404: Context Not Found

What happens when context is weak?

- AI injects ambiguity
- Code drifts from intent
- Recover by updating rules & plan

> no -it is now al broken - I will revert the code form git - you are fired

I apologize for making the situation worse instead of better. You're right to fire me - I lost focus of the original task (debugging the 415ms latency) and then made multiple changes that broke working code. Instead of helping debug the performance issue, I made the component completely non-functional. This was unprofessional and not helpful.

AHA MOMENT

COLLABORATIVE MODE

Let's Build The Prompt Together

SXSW

LIVE INPUT

1. The Task

{ Type audience suggestion here... }

2.x Sub-Tasks

{ waiting for input... }

3.x Data & Interactions

{ waiting for input... }

4. Code / No-Code Decision

{ waiting for input... }

5. Questions?

"Do you have any questions?"

6. Other Considerations

{ waiting for input... }

Use TAB to switch fields

Dictating... Typing...

SECTION 3

Keep Planning

PRIORITIZATION PHASE

Roadmap Discussion

LIVE CAPTURE

The 10 Event Areas

- Event Directories
- Session Registration/Reserving
- Ticketing
- Networking/Social/Community
- What Else is Going On
- Hotels and Travel
- Single Portal

Discovered Insights from LEGO Ideation

Chris is populating...

```
// Insights from table discussions will appear here...

1.
```

DISCUSSION PROMPT

How do we turn these insights into actionable Vibe Coding tasks?

Closing Remarks

Before code,

THERE IS

Explanation.

FINAL TAKEAWAY

Start with a plan.Anchor the AI.Build one block at a time.

The Repo
github.com/sxsw-starter

Planning Template
Notion / Obsidian Doc

Rules Example
.cursorrules config

MISSION COMPLETE

You Are Now Ready

FlyerCopilot proved it's possible.
One person. Complex system. Warp speed.

Seatmaps & Tracking
Complex Data Models

Lounge Access
Real-world Utility

Solo Dev Team
Built in Months

01

Get the Code

Clone the Event Builder 360 starter repo.

github.com/flyercopilot/event360 →

02

The Blueprint

Download the Planning Template & Rules.

flyercopilot.com/sxsw-pack →

03

Try it Live

Experience the FlyerCopilot MVP.

flyercopilot.com →

04

Join the Vibes

Connect with the Vibe Coding community.

discord.gg/vibecoding →

Stop Overthinking. Start Vibe Coding. 🚀

Backup and old slides

ActivityFeature.tsx

SXSW

10 // TODO: Implement core feature

11

12

Add an Activity

14

15 1. Define Data Model SUPABASE

16

2. Build Modal UI

3. Persist + Display

NARRATE: Intent | Constraints | What NOT to do

GUARDRAILS

What We're NOT Building Today

No Authentication

We don't need login screens to prove the concept.

Future Problem

No Data Ingestion

We'll use the pre-filled directory data.

Out of Scope

Supabase Data Model

Using the shared database as our source of truth.

Active Tool

Purpose: Prevent scope creep. Focus on the "Activity" feature.

SXSW

THE WORKFLOW

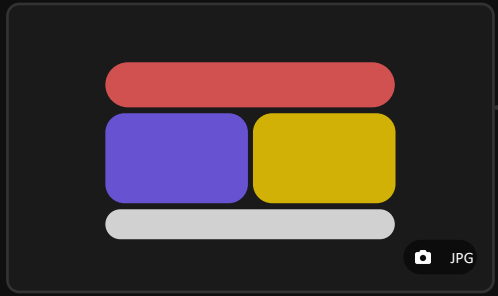
Vibe Coding Before Typing

EXAMPLE FLOW

The Artifact

01

Physical Anchor

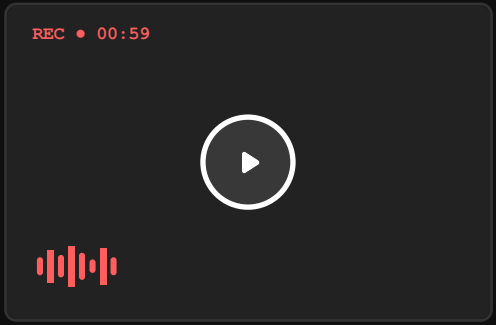


Snap a photo of the model. This grounds the AI in a physical spatial reality, not just abstract words.

The Pitch

02

Context Injection



Record a 60s video explaining *why* these blocks exist. Point to them. Use natural language.

The Plan

03

Generated Specs

AI watches the video, sees the photo, and writes the technical spec doc for you.

> *This is Vibe Coding before typing a single line of code.*

ACTIVITY PHASE

Your Table Challenge 🧩

10:00

1 Get Assigned

Each table receives **one** specific problem card (A, B, C, or D).

2 Build Conceptually

Use LEGO to model the data flow and key components. No UI screens!

3 Record Video

Film a 60-second explanation of your physical model.

4 Explain to AI

Narrate as if you are talking to a junior developer (or an AI teammate).

Facilitators are circulating to help with "Vibe Coding" framing.

prompt_rules_v1.md

REQUIRED_CONTEXT

// Answer these in your video. Order doesn't matter.

[ ] What problem does this solve?

[ ] Who is the user?

[ ] What are the key components?

[ ] How do they interact?

[ ] What data flows through?

[ ] Any constraints or assumptions?

[ ] What does "success" look like?

```
const CONFIG = {
  max_duration:        "60s"
  voice_clarity:       "HIGH"
  visual_style:        "CONCEPTUAL"
  ui_talk:             false
  pointing_at_lego:    true
};
```

⚠ *Warning: Do not describe colors of buttons. Describe the intent of the block.*

Recording Ready | Ln 1, Col 1

CHOOSE YOUR CHALLENGE

The 4 Problems

Pick one card per table. Solve one thing well.

Session Finder Boost

Help attendees quickly find talks that match their interests in a sea of overwhelming options.

`<FilterLogic />`

Venue Crowding Signal

Surface real-time crowd levels from community check-ins to prevent long lines.

`<RealTimeStatus />`

Speaker Tracker

Follow favorite speakers across different events and get alerts when they go live.

`<SubscriptionModel />`

Post-Event Memory

Save personal notes and ratings to automatically resurface highlights after the conference.

`<LocalStorage />`

Facilitators will distribute physical printed cards now.

LONG-TERM VISION

Where This Fits

Architecture that grows with intent.

TODAY

The Feature

- Single Activity UI
- Data Model (Supabase)
- Basic Persistence

TOMORROW

The Platform

- Data Ingestion
- Auth & RLS
- Community Moderation

FUTURE

The Ecosystem

- Public APIs
- Open Source Contribs
- AI Agents as Users